

MOUSE, DWARF, AND FORK-MARKED LEMURS

Among the smallest of all primates, the members of the family Cheirogaleidae have short limbs and large eyes. All are nocturnal, arboreal inhabitants of forests in Madagascar, and become torpid to survive the dry season.

12–15 cm
4¾–6 in

GREY MOUSE LEMUR *Microcebus murinus*

An omnivore, this lemur's diet includes insects, flowers, and fruits.

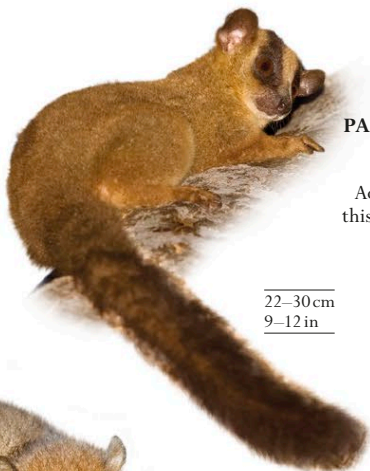
The young are carried in their mother's mouth if moved (rather than clinging on to her fur).



PALE FORK-MARKED LEMUR *Phaner pallescens*

Adapted to eat tree gum, this lemur has a long tongue and large premolars for chiselling bark.

22–30 cm
9–12 in



EASTERN RUFOUS MOUSE LEMUR *Microcebus rufus*

Inhabiting a range of forest habitats, this omnivorous species consumes a variety of fruits, insects, and gum.

10–15 cm
4–6 in



short limbs

GREATER DWARF LEMUR *Cheirogaleus major*

This solitary lemur feeds mainly on fruits and nectar. It stores fat in its tail during the wet season.

26–30 cm
10–12 in



SPORTIVE LEMURS

The family Lepilemuridae consists of the sportive lemurs of Madagascar. These medium-sized lemurs have a prominent muzzle and large eyes, and are strictly arboreal and nocturnal. Their low-energy, leafy diet means that they are among the least active of all primates.

19–26 cm
7½–10 in

WHITE-FOOTED SPORTIVE LEMUR *Lepilemur leucopus*

Greyish above and white below, this lemur spends lengths of time perched vertically on tree trunks, in between bouts of foraging for food.



23–26 cm
9–10 in

BLACK-STRIPED SPORTIVE LEMUR *Lepilemur dorsalis*

This species lives in moist forest in N.W. Madagascar and nearby islands. It has a blunt muzzle and small ears.

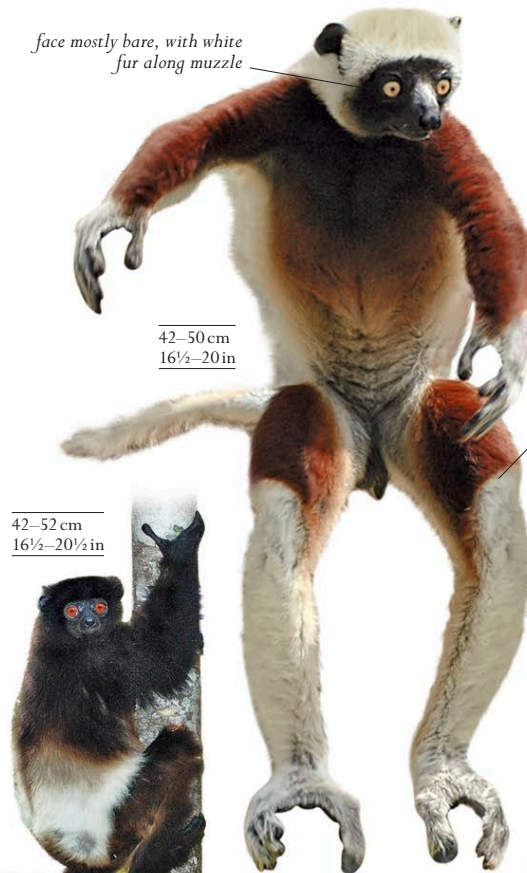


SIFAKAS AND RELATIVES

The largest lemurs – the indri and sifakas – and the smaller avahis or woolly lemurs form the Indriidae of Madagascar. All members have long, powerful limbs for leaping between trees, and, with the exception of the indri, a long tail.

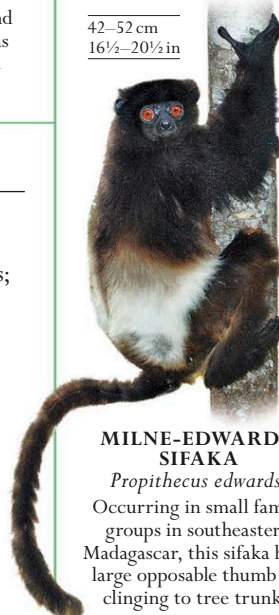
face mostly bare, with white fur along muzzle

42–50 cm
16½–20 in



long hind limbs

42–52 cm
16½–20½ in



MILNE-EDWARD'S SIFAKA *Propithecus edwardsi*

Occurring in small family groups in southeastern Madagascar, this sifaka has a large opposable thumb for clinging to tree trunks.

COQUEREL'S SIFAKA *Propithecus coquereli*

Like other sifakas, this primate crosses open ground by skipping on its hind legs, using its forearms for balance.

40–50 cm
16–20 in



VERREAUX'S SIFAKA *Propithecus verreauxi*

Found in S.W. Madagascar, this sifaka is capable of leaping through cactus-like vegetation on its long legs without being injured.

64–72 cm
25–28 in



INDRI *Indri indri*

The largest member of the lemur group, this is the only species to have a short, vestigial tail.

AYE-AYE

There is only one species in the Daubentoniidae – the aye-aye of Madagascar. This nocturnal primate has large, bare ears; a shaggy coat; very long fingers; and continually growing incisor teeth.

30–37 cm
12–14½ in

AYE-AYE *Daubentonia madagascariensis*

The aye-aye uses its elongated middle finger for locating and extracting insect larvae from dead wood.

